

Front Range USA Pool League Local By-laws.

Front Range Pool League

www.frusapl.com

USAPL #2222 - BCAPL #2345

League Operator: Mark L.(Slam)

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Front Range USA Pool League(FRUSAPL) abides by Cue Sports International (CSI) and USA Pool League rules. Complete rules available at www.playcsipool.com & www.frusapl.com

Noted deviations are outlined in these bylaws.

All weekly match scores must be submitted using the Free USAPL Scoring app.
ALL RACKS/GAMES MUST BE COMPLETED REGARDLESS OF SCORE/WIN SCENERIO.

1. Splitting Tables:

It is expected that Double Play divisions use one table for each format.

If the host location has more tables available for league play,
the captains may agree to start the matches on two or more tables.

Players are responsible for splitting quarters or green fees.

2. Lag:

Each player starts with a ball behind the head string on either side of the long string.

They simultaneously shoot, aiming for their ball to strike the foot cushion
and return toward the head rail.

The player whose ball lands closest to the head rail wins the lag.

A player loses the lag if their ball hits a side cushion, is pocketed,
jumps off the table, or crosses the long string (center diamond).

The winner can opt to break or make their opponent break.

3. Racking:

You must rack for yourself when breaking. All formats are alternating break.

Players alternate the break regardless of who wins the previous rack.

The balls should be racked as tightly as possible. Your opponent may inspect the rack and
require a re-rack if not satisfied, but must not touch any ball(s).

Please refrain from tapping balls.

4. All shots are call Pocket shots: (Exception: 9-Ball)

Except for the break, the shooter must call the intended object ball and intended pocket before the shot is made.

This is a "Gentleman's Call Pocket" game.

The shooter is not required to call obvious shots.

Even if shooting the 8-ball, or 10-ball(although it is **highly encouraged** to do so).

If the called object ball falls into the called pocket(without fouling), it is a legal shot.

Even if the called object ball unintentionally contacts another ball(s) and/or a cushion(s) prior to going into the pocket.

As a general rule, bank shots, caroms, and combination shots should be called as they may not be obvious to the opponent.

Players do not need to call every kiss, carom, and ball/rail contacted.

Only the intended ball and the pocket need to be called..

5. Legal shot:

To be legal, the cue ball must initially hit a legal ball (as per the game's rules), or it can simultaneously(split) hit both legal and illegal balls.

After the cueball/object ball contact:

A ball must be pocketed, or

Any ball or the cue ball must hit a cushion.

Split hits:

A split hit occurs when the cue ball strikes both a legal and an illegal object ball at the same time.

If the referee (or the shooter in the absence of a referee) can not tell which ball is struck first, it is a legal hit and the call goes to the shooter.

6. Jump shots and Masses:

Masse, Jump shots, and jump cues are permitted,
unless otherwise prohibited by the "house rules" of the host establishment.

All jump shots must be legal by striking down on the cue ball.

"Scooping" the cue ball is illegal and will result in a foul.

7. Safeties:

A safety must be called by the shooter prior to making the shot.(exception 9-Ball).

Please ensure your opponent knows you plan on playing a safety.

If a safety is called in 8-ball and an object ball falls into a pocket during the safety,
the object ball stays in the pocket and the shooter's turn is ended.

A safety called overrides what may be considered an obvious "Gentleman's call".

If a safety is called in 10-ball and an object ball falls into a pocket(illegally pocketed ball), the opponent may either accept the table in its current position or require the shooter to shoot again from the resulting position. - *See illegally pocketed ball in the official CSI 10 Ball rules.*

8. Calling a Foul:

(CSI Rule 1-23): A foul may only be called by a player playing in a game or a referee.

Tournaments and CSI events will follow the current CSI/USAPL rules
governing unauthorized foul calls and coaching.

**However, during normal weekly league play, a foul called by someone other than a
player playing in a game or a referee may result
in a Sportsmanship Violation/Warning.**

**Repeated intentional violations may result in sanctions including,
but not limited to: loss of a rack, match, and/or penalty points.**

9. Ball in Hand Fouls:

If a player commits a foul, his/her opponent will begin their turn with ball in hand anywhere on the table.

The following acts, including but not limited to, are ball in hand fouls:

Failure to complete a legal hit.

Repeated violation of the rules on coaching.

Scratching with the cue ball. This includes not only the situation where the cue ball falls into a pocket, but also when the player accidentally touches or moves the cue ball other than with the tip of the cue in a stroking motion or when the player touches an object ball with their hand, and is also holding the cue ball.

It is a foul if you cause any ball to be jumped off the table.

It is a foul if you strike the cue ball more than once with the cue. This is known as a double hit and commonly occurs when the cue ball and target object ball are very close together or touching each other.

It is a foul if the player shoots while any balls are still in motion from the previous shot. A spinning ball is a ball in motion.

It is a foul if the shooter, coach, or any other person marks the table or rail in any way to aid in the execution of the shot. This includes placing chalk on the rail, wetting a finger, or any other method used to provide an aiming target for the shooter.

The coach may point at a spot on a the table as long as no marking is made and no balls are touched.

It is a foul if the shooter disturbs more than one object ball or a disturbed object ball touches any other ball. The opponent does not have the option to restore the balls to the previously undisturbed position.

Please see the official CSI rule book and the USAPL handbook for more details.

10. Player Time Outs:

All skill levels:

Each player is allowed one timeout per game.

With no more than three timeouts per set.

Timeouts are limited to 90 seconds.

A Timeout may be called by the shooter or anyone on the shooter's team.

Timeout must be acknowledged by the opposing player
(not the opposing player's teammates) before the timeout is granted.

Team Limit:

Five Match Format: Each team is allocated a maximum of 10 timeouts for a match.
Therefore, if a team uses 3 timeouts for the first 3 players, the remaining two players
will have only 1 timeout available to share.

For Double Play Divisions, the team limit is 10 timeouts per format.

National Rule - STRICTLY ENFORCED AT ALL TOURNAMENTS:

Once a timeout is called and the coach is named, only that coach may confer with the shooter.
No other player may offer an opinion or advice to the shooter or the coach.

Amended for weekly play only: Coach may confer with one other team member at the table.
However the shooter must back away from the table and not confer with any other teammates.
Timeout is still restricted to the national rule of 90 seconds.

11. Coaching vs. Communication:

While it's not a player's turn at the table, they can engage in
quiet conversation with teammates, including discussing game strategy.

This is considered normal team communication.

However, once the opponent's turn is finished and all balls have stopped moving,
all match-related communication must cease immediately.

Discussions and questions about rules shall not be considered a timeout.

12. Game Scoring:

8-Ball:

The winner of each game receives 14 points regardless of how the game is won.

The opponent receives 1 point for each ball of their group
(i.e. solids or stripes) that is pocketed(down).

Points are awarded regardless of how pocketed (**except for set winning ball**).

The winner of the game does **not** earn 1 point for each ball of their group pocketed.

The winner earns 14 points total for a game win.

USAPL Winning Ball Rule:

Any ball that wins a set, must be legally pocketed by the player needing that ball to win.

If your opponent makes your winning ball,
that ball is deferred until you legally pocket a ball.

If a “winning ball” is illegally pocketed, the following stipulations apply:

- Your inning ends and any foul occurred is applied normally.
 - The point for the illegally pocketed ball is deferred,
until you legally pocket another ball in that game.
- If you do not legally pocket any more balls in that game,
the illegally pocketed ball is not scored.
- You cannot win the set on an illegally pocketed ball.

9-Ball & 10-Ball:

The winner of each game receives 14 points regardless of how the game is won.

The opponent receives 1 point for each ball they legally pocketed.

Illegally pocketed balls are counted as dead balls.

Neither player earns a point for the dead ball(s).

The winner of the game does **not** earn 1 point for each ball legally pocketed.

The winner earns 14 points total for a game win.

**ALL RACKS/GAMES MUST BE COMPLETED
REGARDLESS OF SCORE/WIN SCENERIO**

Weekly Dues and Sanction Fee:

Sanction Fee: \$25 per year, per player – BCAPL & Dual Sanctioned Divisions Only
(USAPL/BCAPL).

Sanction fee is due the 1st week of play for each player.

If previously sanctioned for the current year, player does not need to pay another sanction fee.

Dues are \$10 per player, per match.

Single Play Team Total: \$50

Double Play Team Total: \$100

Full team dues only – no partial payments. Partial payments may be treated as unpaid.

Always include team name & scheduled match date for all payment types.

Payment Types:

Cash Payment:

Drop in **RED** dropbox at Legends Brews & Cues.

Look for envelopes near the box, or ask a staff member.

Electronic Payment:



Front Range USA Pool
League 

Scan to pay \$frusapl

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venmo

**Captains of each team are responsible to collect the weekly dues from the players
and to submit those dues to the League. ***

Team dues must be received within 48 hours of the date the match is **scheduled.**

(unless otherwise stated in these by-laws)

Please see makeup and forfeit sections for more details.

LATE FEE:

Failure to pay dues within 48 hours of match scheduled/played date will result in a \$20 administrative fee for your team, unless waived by League Operator.

Teams will forfeit all matches until dues + any late fees are up to date.

Teams are responsible for any dues + late fees for forfeits due to prior unpaid dues.

Teams must be up to date on all weekly dues to play each week, and to be eligible for prizes, awards, payouts, playoffs, local tournaments, or any higher level tournament.

All dues, player sanction fees, and other fees must be current before players/team may be eligible for any FRUSAPL/USAPL/BCAPL/CSI events and/or tournaments.

****The captain's responsibility to FRUSAPL exists regardless of whether the captain has successfully collected the money from individual team members. A dispute between a captain and an individual player regarding that player's payment does not relieve the team of its obligation to pay the league. Captains should maintain whatever internal records they consider necessary to track player payments.***

Makeup Matches:

The team captain requesting a makeup match must notify the League Operator at least 24 hours in advance of the originally scheduled match date.

If both teams are requesting a makeup match, both captains must notify the L.O. at least 24 hours in advance of the originally scheduled match date.

FAILURE TO NOTIFY THE L.O. AT LEAST 24 HOURS IN ADVANCE, WILL RESULT IN A FORFEIT OF THE REQUESTING TEAM. (see forfeits section)

The League Operator may approve an exception to the make-up notification deadline/forfeit, when circumstances reasonably justify it.

Captains:

It is the responsibility of the teams/captains to communicate and schedule a make up match.

Including date, time, and location(if host location is not available).

Please notify the league operator when the match is scheduled, and when it is completed.

The league operator is not responsible for scheduling make up matches.

If assistance is needed to contact the other team/captain and/or to find a host location for the make up match, please contact the league operator.

Makeup Match Dues:

The team requesting a makeup match must pay their full team dues as if the originally scheduled match date was played.

The team that did not request the makeup match will pay dues when the makeup match is played or forfeited.

Make up Match Deadline:

No make up matches are allowed within 7 days of the session end date.

The League Operator may approve an exception to the make-up deadline, when circumstances reasonably justify it.

Non – Complete Penalty:

If a make-up match is not completed and/or dues paid, by the deadline, a \$20 administrative charge may be assessed against a team responsible for an uncompleted make-up match.

This may be in addition to the late fee(if applicable) as outlined above.

The League Operator may determine whether the failure was attributable to one team, both teams, or circumstances beyond either team's control.

Any applicable penalty may be assessed accordingly.

Including administrative/late fees and/or forfeit scoring for the games, sets, and/or match(es) not played.

All dues, player sanction fees, and other fees must be current before any team may be eligible for any FRUSAPL/USAPL/BCAPL/CSI tournaments.

Playbacks:

Please see USAPL Handbook for full details.

A team may use one player to compete in a max of two sets of a match.

However the following stipulations apply:

- The teams must still pay **full team dues**.
- The team must notify the opppsoing team of the possibility of a playback **before the match starts**.
- Only **one player per team per night** may play more than one set.
Double Play divsions may have one playback per format.
- The **opposing team** chosses which player will play twice, selected from among all players who competed in that match.

Forfeits:

FRUSAPL discourages forfeits, except under extreme circumstances.

Teams should make every effort to play every set of every match as scheduled.

Teams should also complete any and all makeup matches.

Both teams must pay dues in the case of any forfeit(s).

FORFEIT WILL BE RCORDED IF:

TEAM FAILS TO NOTIFY THE L.O. THAT A MAKEUP MATCH IS NEEDED.

TEAM HAS LESS THAN 2 PLAYERS AVAIALBALE AT THE SCHEDULED

MATCH TIME AND/OR A 3rd DOES NOT ARRIVE BEFORE THE

CONCLUSION OF THE FIRST SET(S).

The League Operator may approve an exception to the forfeit notification deadline, when circumstances reasonably justify it.

The USAPL hanbook national rule states that each forfeited set is scored as 200-0.

This will be enforced at **ALL** tournament levels.

AMENDED FOR WEEKLY PLAY: In the Front Range USA Pool League, forfeits will be scored as 100-0 for each forfeited set.

Unsportsmanlike Conduct:

The Front Range USA Pool League will not tolerate unsportsmanlike conduct. Following the rules regarding sportsmanship as specified in The Official Rules of CueSports International, the BCAPL, & USAPL Handbooks.

Specific attention and scrutiny will be given to the following situations:

- A. Failure to comply with league rules**
- B. Displays of anger, violence, threats, or poor sportsmanship in general**
- C. Rating manipulation (sandbagging)**
- D. Illegal coaching to avoid taking a time-out**

Penalties for Unsportsmanlike Conduct:

Penalties for unsportsmanlike conduct may range from a warning to permanent expulsion.

Any pattern or history of unsportsmanlike conduct may affect this decision.

The League Operator has reasonable discretion to determine the appropriate penalty based on the severity, circumstances, and history of the violation.

Some specific possible penalties include:

Warning: Any warning to an offending member or team.

Forfeiture of points: Points may be deducted for any game, set, or match..

Removal as captain or coach: A league member that is frequently involved in disputes may lose the privilege to act as a team captain or coach.

Disqualification from post-season tournaments: A player may be barred from playing in any team tournaments due to unsportsmanlike conduct, regardless of eligibility status. In severe cases, a team may be prohibited from participation in postseason play, including forfeiture of any prize money and/or awards.

Suspension: A member or team may be suspended from all league events for a period to be determined by management. The period of a suspension may be defined or may be open-ended.

Expulsion: A member or team that has shown themselves to be unfit to participate may be expelled from the league. Their membership will be revoked, they will not be allowed at any league event, and they will not receive any refund of league fees.

Rules suspended or modified for weekly league play:

The USA Pool League is, above everything else, a recreational league. While there are plenty of opportunities to compete on the local, regional and national level, the primary purpose of the league is to create an atmosphere of fun and fellowship. In that spirit, there are some rules which, while perhaps appropriate for a regional or national tournament, will be modified or suspended during normal weekly league play.

The following rules will be so modified:

CSI rule 1.3

Makes it a ball in hand foul for any player to use a cell phone, electronic device or earpieces of any kind. The purpose of this rule is to avoid unauthorized communication, and presumably coaching, between the player and their teammates. **This rule is suspended for weekly league play(will be enforced in tournament play). However, use of a cell phone or electronic device by a player during a weekly league play match which delays a match could be considered a sportsmanship violation.**

CSI rule 1.8

Makes it a ball in hand foul if the player or any of his or her teammate's practice while a match is in progress. **This rule is suspended for weekly league and FRUSAPL tournament play(may be enforced at state level events and above).** Members of a team who are not involved in a match are encouraged to practice and enjoy the evening. Players who are involved in an active match are not permitted to play and/or practice on another table while the match is in progress. Delaying a match may constitute committing a sportsmanship violation.

USA POOL LEAGUE National Rule: *Once a timeout is called and the coach is named, only that coach may confer with the shooter. No other player may offer an opinion or advice to the shooter or the coach.* - **ALL TOURNAMENTS WILL FOLLOW THE NATIONAL RULE.**

Amended for weekly play only: Coach may confer with one other team member at the table. However the shooter must back away from the table and not confer with any other teammates.

Timeout is still restricted to the national rule of 90 seconds.